

# Rankkw: Google Ads API Design Document (v2)

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## 1. Overview

Rankkw is a subscription SaaS for Etsy sellers and small e-commerce businesses. It combines keyword research with a Google Ads management tool, so sellers can research what people search for and then advertise those keywords on Google Search from one place.

- **Keyword planning:** Google search volume, competition, bid ranges and keyword ideas, shown next to Etsy marketplace data.
- **Google Ads management:** users connect their **own** Google Ads account with Google OAuth and create, manage and report on Search campaigns inside Rankkw.
- **Keyword → campaign workflow:** an "Advertise on Google" / "Add to Google Ads campaign" button in Keyword Search opens the campaign wizard pre-filled with the researched keywords.

## 2. Intended users

- Independent Etsy sellers, small online shops and their marketing staff who advertise their own businesses on Google Search.
- Each user signs in to Rankkw and connects the Google Ads account(s) they already own or manage. Rankkw does not open accounts, resell media, or manage ads on users' behalf without their action.
- Supported campaign type: **Search**.

## 3. Required Minimum Functionality coverage (Search campaigns)

| RMF item                                                                                             | Where it is in Rankkw                                                           | Google Ads API                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Create campaign; set budget; geo + language targeting                                                | Google Ads tab → New campaign wizard (steps Campaign, Targeting)                | GoogleAdsService.Mutate: CampaignBudgetOperation, CampaignOperation, CampaignCriterionOperation (location, language) |
| Bidding: Target CPA (standard + portfolio), Target ROAS (standard + portfolio), Maximize Conversions | Wizard step Campaign; Edit campaign → Bidding; Bidding strategies → Edit target | CampaignOperation (maximize_conversions / maximize_conversion_value / bidding_strategy), BiddingStrategyOperation    |
| Create ad group; add keyword; set match type                                                         | Wizard step Keywords; Keywords report → + Add keywords                          | AdGroupOperation, AdGroupCriterionOperation (keyword text + match type)                                              |
| Add campaign negative keywords                                                                       | Wizard step Keywords; Edit campaign → Negative keywords                         | CampaignCriterionOperation (negative = true)                                                                         |
| Create responsive search ad                                                                          | Wizard step Ad (headlines, descriptions, final URL, paths, live preview)        | AdGroupAdOperation (responsive_search_ad)                                                                            |
| Callout extensions (account level)                                                                   | Google Ads tab → Callouts                                                       | AssetOperation (callout_asset) + CustomerAssetOperation (field_type CALLOUT)                                         |
| Website / call conversion tracking                                                                   | Google Ads tab → Conversion tracking (shows Google tag + event snippet)         | ConversionActionOperation (WEBPAGE, AD_CALL, WEBSITE_CALL)                                                           |

| RMF item                                                                                                 | Where it is in Rankkw                                                           | Google Ads API                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edit campaign settings; edit bidding                                                                     | Campaigns report → Edit (name, budget, networks, countries, languages, bidding) | CampaignOperation / CampaignBudgetOperation updates with field masks                      |
| Pause / enable / remove campaign, ad, keyword                                                            | Pause, Enable, Remove buttons on Campaigns, Ads and Keywords reports            | CampaignOperation, AdGroupAdOperation, AdGroupCriterionOperation (update status / remove) |
| Reporting: customer + campaign (clicks, cost, impressions, conversions, all conversions, status)         | Overview (totals + daily chart) and Campaigns reports                           | GoogleAdsService.Search on customer, campaign                                             |
| Reporting: ad group ad (clicks, cost, impressions, conversions, status)                                  | Ads report                                                                      | Search on ad_group_ad                                                                     |
| Reporting: keyword (metrics, first page CPC, first position CPC, status)                                 | Keywords report                                                                 | Search on ad_group_criterion (position_estimates) + keyword_view                          |
| Reporting: search terms (term, match type, clicks, cost, impressions)                                    | Search terms report                                                             | Search on search_term_view                                                                |
| Reporting: bidding strategies (type, clicks, cost, cost/conv, impressions, avg CPC, conversions, status) | Bidding strategies report                                                       | Search on bidding_strategy (+ campaign-level strategies grouped by type)                  |

## 4. Keyword planning

KeywordPlanIdeaService.GenerateKeywordHistoricalMetrics and GenerateKeywordIdeas provide monthly search volume, 12-month trends, competition and bid ranges for keywords researched in Rankkw (US, UK, CA, AU, DE, FR, IN and a combined "Global" view). These calls use Rankkw's own Google Ads account. Results are cached per keyword and country for 30 days and shared across users, so each keyword is requested at most once a month.

## 5. Authentication and account model

- **Users' own accounts:** "Connect Google Ads" runs Google OAuth 2.0 (authorization code flow, offline access) requesting <https://www.googleapis.com/auth/adwords> plus openid/email. The state parameter is bound to the signed-in Rankkw user.
- **Account discovery:** CustomerService.ListAccessibleCustomers, then customer\_client for managers; the user chooses which client account to work in. Calls to client accounts under a manager send login-customer-id.
- **Token security:** refresh tokens are encrypted at rest (AES-256-GCM) and never sent to the browser. Access tokens are refreshed server-side. Revoked/expired grants prompt the user to reconnect.
- **Disconnect:** the user can disconnect at any time; Rankkw revokes the token at Google and deletes the stored credentials.
- **Keyword planning** (section 4) uses a separate server-side credential for Rankkw's own Google Ads account.

## 6. Safety and user control

- Nothing changes in a Google Ads account unless the user clicks an action. There are no automated rules or background edits.
- New campaigns are always created **PAUSED**. The whole campaign (budget, bidding, targeting, ad group, keywords, negatives, ad) is created in one atomic Mutate request, so a failure creates nothing.
- "Check with Google" sends the same request with `validate_only` before creating. Removals ask for confirmation.
- The wizard enforces Google's limits (headline 30 chars, description 90 chars, 3–15 headlines, 2–4 descriptions, keyword length/words) and reads `conversion_tracking_status` to disable conversion-based bidding until tracking exists.
- Google Ads errors are shown to the user in plain language with the field that failed.

## 7. API usage, quotas and caching

- All Google Ads API calls are server-side. A shared quota guard stops all calls when `RESOURCE_EXHAUSTED` (developer scope) is returned, until Google's retry time; per-second limits wait the requested delay and retry once.
- Reports are cached for 2 minutes per user/account/report and invalidated immediately after any change the user makes.
- Estimated volume: keyword planning is dominated by new unique keywords per day; account management scales with the number of connected sellers (typically tens of report and mutate requests per active user per day).
- **Why Standard Access:** Rankkw's users research many unique keywords and manage their own campaigns daily; the 15,000 daily operations of Basic Access are exhausted on busy days, which blocks every user.

## 8. Data handling

- Google Ads data is shown only to the user who connected the account. Rankkw does not sell, share, or use it for advertising or model training.
- Stored: encrypted refresh token, Google email, list of accessible account names/IDs, selected account. Report data is not stored beyond short caches.
- Privacy policy (<https://rankkw.com/privacy>, section 7) describes the Google Ads data use and the Google API Services User Data Policy Limited Use commitment. Terms: <https://rankkw.com/terms>.

## 9. Screens (for reviewers)

| Screen                                                                        | Path in the app                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Connect Google Ads / account picker                                           | Dashboard → Google Ads (sidebar, Advertising)                                                       |
| New campaign wizard (5 steps + review)                                        | Google Ads → + New campaign                                                                         |
| Reports: Overview, Campaigns, Ads, Keywords, Search terms, Bidding strategies | Google Ads → section tabs + date range + campaign filter                                            |
| Edit campaign (settings, targeting, negatives, bidding)                       | Google Ads → Campaigns → Edit                                                                       |
| Pause / Enable / Remove                                                       | Google Ads → Campaigns / Ads / Keywords rows                                                        |
| Conversion tracking, Callouts                                                 | Google Ads → Conversion tracking / Callouts                                                         |
| Keyword research → campaign                                                   | Dashboard → Keywords → Advertise on Google, or select related keywords → Add to Google Ads campaign |

A reviewer login for rankkw.com, already connected to a Google Ads test account, is provided with the application.